

I do not know where my father's prayer might have been heard, nor if it was heard, nor if the mere fact of the prayer gave him the focusing and intensifying agent which is part of deep subconscious belief. But I know that when he returned to the house he found me sitting up, which had been impossible for me to do a couple of hours before. Sitting up, crying for water, and with my fever "broken" as we used to say.

Another generation, another goal. I have been privileged to see in my own generation, and with my own son, how deep belief can bring "impossible" achievement.

When my son Blair was born without ears, and without many vital parts of the usual hearing equipment, I conceived the idea that he *would* hear. Let me make short shrift of the obstacles that were put in Blair's way and mine—the denunciations I received for not allowing him to learn finger-talk, the attempts to wreck his life by making him self-conscious about being "different," and so forth. At any rate, I knew that the subconscious mind can work wonders toward establishing health and proper function in the body—when it is so conditioned.

The conscious mind often serves as a sort of sentinel which guards the entrance to the subconscious. Thus, as we say, "A man convinced against his will is of the same opinion still," because his agreement was merely conscious, perhaps a peace-maker rather than a subconscious "change of orders." Or in extraordinary circumstances we are "carried away" and do not act in our accustomed manner, but later return to our ordinary ways of conducting ourselves because no deep-down impression was made.

Hypnotism appears to bypass the conscious mind at some times, and with some people. There is a better and less risky way, however, to reach past the barrier of the conscious and implant instructions in the subconscious, where they will be absorbed and fed back. That way is to give instructions to a sleeping person. The conscious mind sleeps, but the subconscious does not sleep. Recent studies suggest that there are certain stages of sleep in which the mind is more receptive than when it is in other stages, and I am glad to see this modern investigation of the technique. I may have wasted some of my efforts, but my efforts were so long-continued and backed by such belief that they achieved what many others said I never would be able to do.

I spoke to Blair while he slept. I spoke directly to his sub-